

Japan Short-Stay Visa Guide

Ordinary passport holders - multi-citizenship reference for KelanaAI RAG
Compiled and reviewed: 8 September 2026

Purpose: Compact knowledge-base reference for short tourism and other short-term visits to Japan. Visa rules can change, so travelers should verify the latest requirements with Japan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MOFA) or the Japanese embassy/consulate responsible for their place of residence before travel.

1. Core rule

Japan currently lists **74 countries and regions** with short-stay visa-exemption arrangements for ordinary passport holders. The period granted upon landing is generally **90 days**, except **Indonesia and Thailand: 15 days**, and **Brunei and Qatar: 30 days**. Some citizenships are subject to specific passport or registration conditions.

2. Visa-exempt countries and regions

Region	Countries / regions
Asia	Brunei; Indonesia; Malaysia; Republic of Korea; Singapore; Thailand; Hong Kong; Macao; Taiwan
North America	Canada; United States
Latin America and the Caribbean	Argentina; Bahamas; Barbados; Brazil; Chile; Costa Rica; Dominican Republic; El Salvador; Guatemala; Honduras; Panama; Paraguay; Peru; Mexico; Suriname; Uruguay
Oceania	Australia; New Zealand
Middle East	Israel; Qatar; Türkiye; United Arab Emirates
Africa	Lesotho; Mauritius; Tunisia
Europe	Andorra; Austria; Belgium; Bulgaria; Croatia; Cyprus; Czech Republic; Denmark; Estonia; Finland; France; Germany; Greece; Hungary; Iceland; Ireland; Italy; Latvia; Liechtenstein; Lithuania; Luxembourg; Malta; Monaco; Montenegro; Netherlands; North Macedonia; Norway; Poland; Portugal; Romania; San Marino; Serbia; Slovakia; Slovenia; Spain; Sweden; Switzerland; United Kingdom

3. Important passport and registration conditions

Indonesia: Visa exemption applies only to nationals who have an ICAO-compliant ePassport and complete the required pre-departure registration. The exempt stay is 15 days. Registration is valid for three years or until passport expiry, whichever comes first.

Thailand, Brazil, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Montenegro, Serbia, United Arab Emirates: Visa exemption applies only to holders of an ICAO-compliant ePassport.

Malaysia: Visa exemption applies to holders of an ICAO-compliant ePassport. Travelers without such an ePassport are advised to obtain a visa in advance.

Taiwan: Visa exemption is limited to passport holders whose passport includes a personal ID number.

Hong Kong: Visa exemption applies to eligible Hong Kong SAR passport holders and qualifying British National (Overseas) passport holders with right of residence in Hong Kong.

Macao: Visa exemption applies to holders of a Macao SAR passport.

Barbados, Türkiye, Lesotho: Visa exemption applies to holders of an ICAO-compliant Machine-Readable Passport (MRP).

Qatar: Visa exemption applies to nationals who have registered an ICAO-compliant ePassport with a Japanese diplomatic mission. The exempt stay is 30 days.

Uruguay: Japan does not recognize the newer Uruguayan ordinary passport version issued after 16 April 2025 that omits place of birth. The visa exemption continues for holders of the older recognized passport version.

4. Special note for Indonesian ordinary passport holders

For Indonesian nationals residing in Indonesia, the Japan Visa Exemption System (JAVES) allows eligible holders of an ICAO-compliant ePassport to complete pre-departure visa-exemption registration online. Official Japanese consular guidance updated 11 May 2026 states that eligible purposes include tourism, business, family visits and other short visits, with a **maximum stay of 15 days**.

Online registration processing is normally **2 working days** (including the application day), although it may take longer around Japanese public holidays. The traveler must display the live electronic **Visa Exemption Registration Notice** on a smartphone or tablet; a screenshot or printed copy is not accepted.

5. If the traveler is not visa-exempt

A traveler whose citizenship is not in the visa-exempt list, or who does not satisfy the special passport or registration condition for their citizenship, should obtain the appropriate visa before travel unless another exemption applies.

Japan also operates the **JAPAN eVISA** system for eligible short-term tourism applicants. As of 15 May 2026, eligibility depends on nationality and place of residence. Some applicants can apply directly online, while in several countries and regions applications must be made through an accredited agency. The eVISA is a single-entry short-term tourism visa, generally for a stay of up to 90 days, subject to nationality-specific rules.

Travelers using an eVISA must display the live online **Visa Issuance Notice** at the airport in an internet-enabled environment; a PDF file, screenshot or printed copy is not accepted.

6. Examples for KelanaAI testing

Traveler	Short-stay guidance
United States passport	Visa-exempt for a short tourism visit, generally 90 days.
Canadian passport	Visa-exempt for a short tourism visit, generally 90 days.
United Kingdom passport	Visa-exempt; 90 days are granted upon landing. Bilateral arrangements can allow a longer stay, but an extension is required for more than 90 days.
Singapore passport	Visa-exempt for a short tourism visit, generally 90 days.
Indonesian ePassport	Eligible for visa exemption only after required registration; maximum exempt stay 15 days.
Thai ePassport	Visa-exempt for up to 15 days.
Brunei passport	Visa-exempt for up to 30 days.
Qatari registered ePassport	Visa-exempt for up to 30 days.
Nationality not on the 74-country/region list	Generally requires an appropriate visa before travel; check the Japanese mission for the place of residence and eVISA eligibility.

7. Official sources

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Japan - Exemption of Visa (Short-Term Stay)
https://www.mofa.go.jp/j_info/visit/visa/short/novisa.html

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Japan - The JAPAN eVISA system
https://www.mofa.go.jp/j_info/visit/visa/visaonline.html

Consulate-General of Japan in Denpasar - JAVES ePassport visa-exemption registration
https://www.dennasar.id.emb-japan.go.id/itor_ia/11_000001_00761.html

RAG note: The document uses explicit country names, stay periods, passport conditions and headings so a retrieval system can match traveler questions to the relevant passage.